Topic 16 — Environmental Organizations (India)

Covers syllabus (click to expand)

MoEFCC (पर्यावरण, वन और जलवायु परिवर्तन मंत्रालय) | CPCB (केंद्रीय प्रदूषण नियंत्रण बोर्ड) | SPCB | NGT | NEERI | WII | BSI | ZSI | FSI

Sources baked in: EPA 1986, Water Act 1974, Air Act 1981, NGT Act 2010, MoEFCC, ISFR 2023, UPPCS PYQs 2018–2025 **Weight:** ★★★ High — org ↔ function ↔ HQ ↔ report matching **Last verified:** August 2026

Current Affairs (this topic)

- MoEFCC / CPCB / SPCB / NBA HQ and function traps stay stable; scheme rebrands are the CA layer.
- NEERI = Nagpur remains a classic organisation location trap.

16.1 Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change (MoEFCC)

Identity: Nodal ministry | 1985/2014 | Delhi | Category A EC | PARIVESH

- **MoEFCC** is India's **nodal ministry** for environment, forests, wildlife, and climate change policy.
- It was established as **Ministry of Environment & Forests (MoEF) in 1985**.
- It was renamed **MoEFCC in 2014** when climate change was formally added to the mandate.
- **Headquarters** is **New Delhi**.
- MoEFCC administers **EPA 1986** (पर्यावरण संरक्षण 1986), **Wildlife (Protection) Act 1972**, **Forest (Conservation) Act 1980**, and **Biological Diversity Act 2002** (जैव विविधता अधिनियम 2002).
- It grants **Category A Environmental Clearance** through the **Expert Appraisal Committee (EAC)**.
- The **PARIVESH portal** is MoEFCC's online system for EC applications.
- MoEFCC approves **forest land diversion** under FCA 1980.
- It coordinates India's role in **UNFCCC (यूएनएफसीसीसी), CBD, and Montreal Protocol (मॉन्ट्रियल प्रोटोकॉल)**.
- MoEFCC **does not** set **NAAQS** pollution standards — that is **CPCB's** role.
- MoEFCC **does not** publish **ISFR** — that is **FSI's** role.

Logic: MoEFCC was **not** created in 1972. **1972** = Stockholm Conference + WPA.

Function	Body
Category A EC	**MoEFCC**

Function	Body
Forest clearance	**MoEFCC**
NAAQS standards	**CPCB**
Category B EC	**SEIAA**
EC appeals	**NGT**

16.2 Central Pollution Control Board (CPCB) (केंद्रीय प्रदूषण नियंत्रण बोर्ड) & State Pollution Control Board (SPCB) (राज्य प्रदूषण नियंत्रण बोर्ड)

Identity: Water Act 1974 | CPCB Delhi | SPCB consent | NOT EC authority

CPCB

- **CPCB** was established in **1974** under the **Water (Prevention and Control of Pollution) Act, 1974**.
- The **Air Act 1981** extended its role to air pollution control.
- **Headquarters** is **New Delhi**.
- CPCB advises the Centre, sets **National Ambient Air Quality Standards (NAAQS)**, and coordinates all **SPCBs**.
- It runs national **air and water monitoring** programmes.
- CPCB administers **EPR portals** for plastic, e-waste, battery, and tyre waste.
- CPCB **does not grant Environmental Clearance** — MoEFCC/SEIAA do.
- CPCB **does not publish ISFR** — FSI does.
- CPCB **does not prepare the Annual Groundwater Quality Report** — **CGWB** does.

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2025, Q70

Annual Groundwater Quality Report 2024 prepared by:

1. CPCB 2. Central Water Commission 3. CGWB

Show answer

Ans: B (Only 3) — **CGWB**, not CPCB.

SPCB

- Every state has a **State Pollution Control Board** under the **Water Act 1974** and **Air Act 1981**.
- SPCBs issue **Consent to Establish (CTE)** and **Consent to Operate (CTO)** to industries.
- They enforce **CPCB-prescribed standards** through inspection, sampling, and penalties.
- SPCBs work under **CPCB technical guidance** and **state government** administrative control.
- **UPPCB** is Uttar Pradesh's board with HQ at **Lucknow**.
- UPPCB enforces norms on **Kanpur tanneries**, **Ghaziabad/Noida industries**, and **Ganga/Yamuna** discharges.

- SPCB **does not grant Environmental Clearance — SEIAA/MoEFCC** do.

Term	Body	Purpose
Consent (CTE/CTO)	**SPCB**	Pollution control for industry operation
Environmental Clearance	**MoEFCC/SEIAA**	Project impact assessment
Forest Clearance	**MoEFCC**	Forest land diversion

16.3 National Green Tribunal (NGT) (राष्ट्रीय हरित अधिकरण)

Identity: NGT Act 2010 | Delhi HQ | Appeals | 6-month disposal target

- **NGT** was established under the **National Green Tribunal Act, 2010** and became operational in **2011**.
- **Headquarters** is **New Delhi** with regional benches at **Bhopal, Pune, Kolkata, and Chennai**.
- The **Chairperson** must be a retired **Supreme Court judge** or Chief Justice of a High Court.
- NGT hears **civil cases** with substantial environmental questions under EPA, WPA, FCA, Water Act, and Air Act.
- It hears **appeals against Environmental Clearance** decisions by MoEFCC/SEIAA.
- NGT can award **compensation** for environmental damage under the **Polluter Pays** principle.
- The Act targets disposal within **6 months**.
- NGT **does not grant EC** — it **adjudicates appeals**.
- NGT **does not set pollution standards** — CPCB does.
- NGT was established by an **Act of Parliament**. CPCB was constituted under the **Water Act, 1974** — it is **not** a mere executive order body.
- The older **National Environment Appellate Authority (NEAA / NEA)** was created under the **NEAA Act, 1997** to hear appeals on restricted-area industrial siting under EPA.
- After NGT began functioning (**18 October 2010**), the **NEAA stood dissolved**.

> **Logic:** NGT Act = **2010**, not 1986. NEAA 1997 → dissolved after NGT.

16.4 Wildlife Institute of India (WII) (भारतीय वन्यजीव संस्थान)

Identity: 1982 Dehradun | Wildlife research + training | NOT taxonomy

- **WII** was established in **1982** at **Dehradun** under **MoEFCC**.
- It is an autonomous institute for **wildlife research, science, and training**.
- WII trains **Indian Forest Service** and state forest officers.
- It helped delineate India's **10 biogeographic zones** (Rodgers & Panwar, 1988).
- WII develops **tiger census methodology** with NTCA and states.
- WII studies **protected areas**, **human-wildlife conflict**, and habitat (वास स्थान) management.
- WII **does not** maintain national plant/animal species catalogues — **BSI/ZSI** do.

- WII **does not** publish **ISFR** — **FSI** does.

16.5 Botanical Survey of India (BSI) (भारतीय वनस्पति सर्वेक्षण)

Identity: 1890 Kolkata | PLANTS | *Flora of India* | Red Data Book (plants)

- **BSI** was established in **1890** and is headquartered at **Kolkata**.
- It surveys and documents **Indian plant diversity** — flowering plants, ferns, algae, and fungi.
- BSI publishes ***Flora of India*** and state floras.
- It maintains the **Central National Herbarium (पादप संग्रहालय)** at Shibpur, Howrah.
- BSI publishes the **Red Data Book of Indian Plants**.
- BSI surveys **plants only** — **not animals**.

16.6 Zoological Survey of India (ZSI) (भारतीय प्राणी सर्वेक्षण)

Identity: 1916 Kolkata | ANIMALS | *Fauna of India* | Red Data Book (animals)

- **ZSI** was established in **1916** and is headquartered at **Kolkata**.
- It surveys and documents **Indian animal diversity** from invertebrates to mammals.
- ZSI publishes the ***Fauna of India*** series.
- It maintains **National Zoological Collections** for species identification.
- ZSI publishes the **Red Data Book of Indian Animals**.
- ZSI supports **CITES** (साइट्स) and **WPA Schedule** listing with scientific data.
- ZSI surveys **animals only** — **not plants**.

Body	Est.	HQ	Kingdom
BSI	1890	Kolkata	**Plants**
ZSI	1916	Kolkata	**Animals**
WII	1982	Dehradun	Wildlife research
FSI	1981	Dehradun	Forest cover

16.7 Forest Survey of India (FSI) (भारतीय वन सर्वेक्षण)

Identity: 1981 Dehradun | Biennial ISFR | Satellite forest mapping

- **FSI** was established in **1981** at **Dehradun** under **MoEFCC**.
- FSI assesses **forest cover** using satellite imagery and ground verification.
- It publishes the **India State of Forest Report (ISFR)** every **two years** — biennial, not annual.
- ISFR reports **forest cover classes**, **tree cover** (वृक्ष आवरण), and **carbon stock** estimates (प्राकलन समिति).

- FSI **does not** monitor industrial air/water pollution — **CPCB/SPCB** do.
- FSI **does not** survey plant/animal species taxonomy — **BSI/ZSI** do.

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2025, Q8 (ISFR link)

ISFR 2023 is published by **FSI**. UP districts with >20% forest cover included **Chandauli and Shravasti** — **Ans: C (2 and 3)**.

Report	Publisher
ISFR	**FSI**
Groundwater Quality Report	**CGWB**
NAAQS bulletin	**CPCB**
Flora of India	**BSI**
Fauna of India	**ZSI**

16.8 National Environmental Engineering Research Institute (NEERI)

Identity: 1958 Nagpur | Ex-CPHERI | CSIR | Environmental science & engineering

- **NEERI** is India's pioneering CSIR laboratory for **environmental science and engineering**.
- It was established in **1958** at **Nagpur** as the **Central Public Health Engineering Research Institute (CPHERI)**.
- Early focus was water supply, sewage disposal, related diseases, and industrial pollution control.
- NEERI works under the **Council of Scientific and Industrial Research (CSIR)** and falls under the **Ministry of Science and Technology**.
- It has zonal laboratories at **Chennai, Delhi, Hyderabad, Kolkata, and Mumbai**.
- NEERI is **not** a pollution-control board and **does not** set NAAQS — that is **CPCB**.
- HQ city: **Nagpur**, not Bengaluru, Hyderabad, or New Delhi.

Body	HQ	Job
NEERI	**Nagpur**	Env. engineering research (CSIR)
CPCB	New Delhi	Pollution standards / monitoring
NGT	New Delhi	Environmental adjudication

16.9 Institutes, Stations & Match Facts

Identity: Antarctica bases | CAZRI Jodhpur | IIFM Bhopal | FRI / IGFRI | ENVIS | INCOIS

- India's Antarctic stations: **Dakshin Gangotri (गंगोत्री) (1983–84)** first base (now supply/transit); **Maitri (1989)**; **Bharati (March 2013)**. Permanent **operational** pair today = **Maitri + Bharati** (not Dakshin Gangotri as active science base).

- **Wildlife Institute of India — Dehradun**. **Forest Research Institute — Dehradun**. **Indian Institute of Forest Management — Bhopal** (not Kolkata).
- **Central Arid Zone Research Institute (CAZRI) — Jodhpur** (ICAR; arid-zone research).
- **Indian Grassland and Fodder Research Institute — Jhansi** (झांसी). **IARI — New Delhi**.
- **National Institute of Nutrition — Hyderabad**. **National Institute of Ayurveda — Jaipur**. **National Institute of Naturopathy — Pune**.
- **Indian Institute of Ecology (पारिस्थितिकी) and Environment — New Delhi** (founded **5 June 1980** teaching).
- **ENVIS Centre on Population and Environment — IIPS Mumbai**.
- **Indian National Centre for Ocean Information Services (INCOIS) — Hyderabad** (1999; Ministry of Earth Sciences).
- **G.B. Pant Institute of Himalayan Environment and Development — Almora** (अल्मोड़ा). **Centre for Ecological Sciences — Bengaluru**.
- **Kailash Sacred Landscape Conservation and Development Initiative (KSLCDI)** partners: **India, China, Nepal**.

> **Logic:** IIFM = **Bhopal**. CAZRI = **Jodhpur**. Operational Antarctica = **Maitri + Bharati**.
